

Governance Overview

How the Foundation is structured, who decides, and how the archive is kept accessible and intact for at least one hundred years. August 2026.

1. Legal structure

The Global Artist Registry Foundation (GARF) is a stichting — a non-profit foundation under Netherlands law — registered in The Hague (KvK 42024490). A stichting has no owners and no shareholders; it exists only to pursue its stated purpose.

- No commercial ownership, no investors, no distribution of profit to any person.
- Perpetual legal continuity: the foundation survives the departure or death of its founders.
- Assets, including archive data and any endowment, are legally locked to the preservation mission.
- Articles of association are public and filed with the Dutch Chamber of Commerce.

2. The board and how decisions are made

- A multi-seat board holds fiduciary responsibility for the 100-Year Preservation Plan.
- Board composition combines art-historical, legal/governance, and technical-archival expertise.
- No single member holds controlling rights; resolutions are passed by recorded majority vote.
- Conflict-of-interest rules require disclosure and abstention on any related-party matter.
- An advisory circle of practising artists, museum registrars, and scholars advises on standards but does not hold voting power.

3. Artist control of data

The Foundation is a custodian, not an owner. Artists, estates, and collectors retain rights in their own records and images.

- Accounts are role-isolated; records are visible only to their owner unless deliberately published.
- Full export at any time in open, non-proprietary formats — no lock-in.
- The Foundation does not sell artworks, take commission, represent artists, or sell data or advertising.

4. Custody, storage and continuity

- Archival storage in redundant, geographically distributed European cloud infrastructure, with regular backups and integrity checking.
- Preservation practice follows recognised standards: OAIS (ISO 14721) for the ingest-management-access pipeline, Dublin Core and PREMIS metadata, and periodic format migration.
- Succession clause: should the Foundation ever be dissolved, the statutes require transfer of the archives to a qualifying heritage institution — the record cannot simply disappear.

5. Identity verification and privacy

Artist identity is confirmed through Veriff, a regulated European identity-verification provider, so that a record can be trusted as authored by the artist.

- Verification is processed by Veriff under GDPR; GARF receives a verification result and the matched legal name, not a stored copy of the document for open circulation.

- Identity data is used solely to confirm authorship, is never sold or shared for marketing, and is retained only as long as needed to evidence the verification.
- Artists may request correction or deletion of personal data under GDPR at any time.

6. Funding and transparency

- Funded by donations, founding supporters, supporting members, institutional partnerships, and grants.
- Free of charge for verified artists; the mission is not dependent on artist fees.
- Annual activity and financial reports published openly once the Foundation is operationally active, with independent audit as scale requires.

Registered form	Stichting (non-profit foundation), Netherlands
Seat	The Hague — Jan Pieterszoon Coenstraat 7, 2595 WP
Chamber of Commerce	KvK 42024490
Preservation horizon	Minimum 100 years
Cost to verified artists	None
Contact	contact@globalartistregistry.org · globalartistregistry.org

This overview summarises governance arrangements for prospective partners, artist organisations, funders, and institutions. It is descriptive and does not replace the Foundation's articles of association, which prevail in all cases.